

**Matt
Capaldi**
Ph.D. Candidate

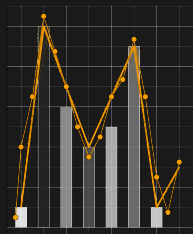
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 Education

Ph.D.	Higher Education Administration Minor in Urban and Regional Planning Dissertation: <i>A collection of essays exploring the link between transportation and college student outcomes</i> University of Florida, FL	Summer 2025 (Expected)
M.Ed.	Research and Evaluation Methodology University of Florida, FL	Fall 2024 (Expected)
M.Ed.	Student Personnel in Higher Education University of Florida, FL	Spring 2020
B.A.	International Relations with Political Science Year Abroad: Providence College, RI University of Birmingham, UK	Summer 2018

 Experience

Graduate Assistant & Fellow	August 2021 – Present
University of Florida, FL	
Teaching Experience	
EDH 7916: Contemporary Research in Higher Education – “The R Class”	
Co-Instructor	Spring 2025
Co-Instructor	Spring 2024
– Took over instruction and grading for the technical R portions of the course following Dr. Skinner’s departure	
– Refreshed the course website including simplifying some of the core content (e.g. loops), updating the .Rmd lesson to Quarto, and adding a Tidyverse to SQL translation lesson	
– 5.0 (Mdn) 4.3 (M) out of 5.0 course evaluation see public results	
Teaching Assistant	Spring 2023
– Assisted Dr. Skinner with 1:1 troubleshooting for lessons and assignments during class and office hours	
– Designed and taught a new lesson on mapping and working with spatial data in R based off a real-world past GA task	
Research Experience	
– Spatially merged meteorological and government emergency response data with IPEDS to explore the impact of extreme weather on colleges	
– Spatially lined up TX community college service areas with high school districts to explore equity of institutional access	
– Gathered data and created tables and visualizations for a report targeted at state policy makers	
– Created a new dataset of state-run merit-based aid programs in the US which led to a new typology being proposed	
Residence Hall Coordinator	July 2020 – May 2021
University of Missouri, MO	
Graduate Community Coordinator	July 2019 – May 2020
University of Florida, FL	



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Summer Sessions Graduate Intern
Georgetown University, DC

Graduate Assistant
University of Florida

Advising Intern
US-UK Fulbright Commission

Student Ambassador
University of Birmingham

May 2019 – July 2019

August 2018 – May 2019

January 2018 – June 2018

January 2015 – June 2018

💡 **Technical Skills**

Regression-Based Analysis

- Ordinary Least Squares
- Logistic
- Cox Proportional Hazard
- Geographically Weighted
- Fixed Effects

Quasi-Experimental Designs

- Propensity Scores
- Instrumental Variables
- Difference in Differences
- Regression Discontinuity

Spatial Statistics

- Spatial Projections & Mapping
- Distance Calculation
- Clusters & Hot-Spots
- Spatial Outlier
- Interpolation

Psychometrics & Latent Variables

- Classical Test Theory
- Factor Analysis
- Item Response Theory
- Basic Computational Psychometrics
- Structural Equation Modeling

Natural Language Processing

- Structural Topic Modeling

Bayesian Statistics

- Bayesian Regression (MCMC)

R

Shiny

Python

Git

Zotero

Quarto & Rmd

Stata

SPSS

Qualtrics

GIS

Typst

Microsoft Office

Published Work

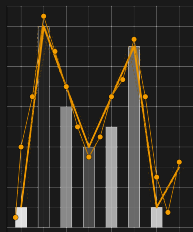
Peer-Reviewed Articles

Capaldi, M. J., & Shin, J. (under review). A time and place for (sustainable) campus planning: using structural topic models to explore variations in planning priorities at large us public colleges. *Research in Higher Education*.

Hu, X., Fernandez, F., Qiu, Y., & **Capaldi, M.** (2024). The good, the bad, and the balanced: a typology of state merit-aid programs for community college students. *Community College Review*, 52(3), 289–314. <https://doi.org/10.1177/00915521241238753>

Capaldi, M. J. (2023). The route to graduation: an exploration of the association between transit stop proximity and pell recipient completion rates at us commuter colleges. *Journal of College Student Retention: Research, Theory & Practice*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/15210251231156421>

Reports



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Fernandez, F., Hu, X., & **Capaldi, M.** (2023). *Exploring equitable public higher education funding models in Illinois*. Partnership for College Completion. <https://partnershipfcc.org/publications/adequacy/>

Commentary Articles

Capaldi, M. J. (2021, December 1). Ensuring equitable public safety responses in college towns. *American City and County*. <https://www.americancityandcounty.com/2021/12/01/ensuring-equitable-public-safety-responses-in-college-towns/>

Fernandez, F., & **Capaldi, M. J.** (2021, October 25). Studying political science motivates college students to register and vote – new research shows. *The Conversation*. <http://theconversation.com/studying-political-science-motivates-college-students-to-register-and-vote-new-research-shows-168440>

Software

Capaldi, M. J. (2024). *IPEDtaS: Automagically Download Labeled .dta IPEDS Files in Stata and R*. Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.13388846>

 Conference Presentations

Workshops

Capaldi, M. J. (2024, November 22). *Automating data retrieval for enhanced reproducibility: using Stata and R to “automagically” download labeled IPEDS data*. ASHE: Association for the Study of Higher Education. <https://capaldi.info/ASHE24/>

Paper Presentations

Capaldi, M. J., & Shin, J. (accepted). *Time and place for (sustainable) planning: a structural topic model analysis of campus master plans*. AERA: American Educational Research Association.

Hu, X., Fernandez, F., & **Capaldi, M. J.** (accepted). *With a Few Dollars More: Examining Community College Merit Aid, Enrollment, and Transfer*. AERA: American Educational Research Association.

Capaldi, M. J. (2024, November 21). *The route to retention: an analysis of transit stop proximity and urban commuter college retention*. ASHE: Association for the Study of Higher Education. <https://capaldi.info/ASHE24/>

Hu, X., Fernandez, F., Qiu, Y., & **Capaldi, M. J.** (2023, April 13). *A typology of state merit aid programs for community college students*. AERA: American Educational Research Association.

 Funding

\$1,000	Dr. Barbara Keener Dissertation Award University of Florida	2024
\$2,500	Lincoln and Lillian Hall Fellowship in Memory of Albert G. Hall University of Florida	2024
\$2,000	Patricia D. Conroy Endowed Scholarship University of Florida	2023
\$31,000 & Tuition	Graduate School Funding Award University of Florida	2021 – 2025